



# Norway



The Kingdom of Norway traces the rugged western coast of Scandinavia. Settlements are largely restricted to southern and coastal areas. Vast oil and natural gas revenues bring prosperity.



## GEOGRAPHY

The western coast is indented with numerous fjords and features tens of thousands of islands. Mountains and plateaus cover most of the country.



## CLIMATE

Mild coastal climate. Inland, the weather is more extreme, with warmer summers and cold, snowy winters.



## PEOPLE & SOCIETY

Fairly homogeneous; influx of refugees from 1990s Bosnian conflict. Strong family tradition despite high divorce rate. Fair-minded consensus promotes female equality, boosted by the generous childcare provision. Wealth is more evenly distributed than in most developed countries. Voted not to join EU in 1994.



**INSIGHT:** Near Narvik, mainland Norway is only 4 miles (7 km) wide



## THE ECONOMY

Western Europe's top oil and natural gas producer: trust fund saves for post-oil future. Metal, chemical, and engineering industries. Generous aid donor. High cost of living.



## FACTFILE

**OFFICIAL NAME:** Kingdom of Norway

**DATE OF FORMATION:** 1905

**CAPITAL:** Oslo

**POPULATION:** 4.81 million

**TOTAL AREA:** 125,181 sq. miles  
(324,220 sq. km)

**DENSITY:** 41 people per sq. mile

**LANGUAGES:** Norwegian\* (Bokmål and Nynorsk), Sámi

**RELIGIONS:** Evangelical Lutheran 89%, other 10%, Roman Catholic 1%

**ETHNIC MIX:** Norwegian 93%, other 6%, Sámi 1%

**GOVERNMENT:** Parliamentary system

**CURRENCY:** Norwegian krone = 100 øre